Syed Samsudeen

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER | BACKEND & AI APPLICATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 7 years of experience designing, developing, deploying, and maintaining business applications. Hands-on experience with PHP, Laravel, Python-based chatbot applications, REST APIs, and AI/LLM-enabled workflows. Experienced in hosting applications on Ubuntu servers, configuring Nginx, domain mappings, HTTPS using Let's Encrypt, and deploying applications with Docker. Contributes to technical architecture, code reviews, mentoring, and delivery of ownership for a 5-member team. Focused on building maintainable backend systems, reliable deployments, and practical AI-enabled solutions.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, Python, SQL, JavaScript

Backend & APIs: Laravel, REST APIs, authentication/authorization, validation, integrations, background jobs/queues

Databases: MySQL/PostgreSQL, schema design, joins, indexing, query optimization

AI & Chatbot Applications: Python chatbot workflows, LLM/API integration, prompt design, RAG, embeddings, vector search

Linux & Web Hosting: Ubuntu, SSH, Nginx, domain mapping, DNS configuration, HTTPS, Let's Encrypt SSL certificates

Containers & Deployment: Docker, container deployment, environment configuration, application hosting, production troubleshooting

Engineering Practices: Git, debugging, code reviews, secure coding, performance optimization

Leadership: Technical design, mentoring, task planning, delivery coordination, stakeholder communication, team support

Development Tools: Cursor, GitHub Copilot Chat, VSCodeIDE, Git platforms.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cognitude Technologies — Senior Software Engineer | Chennai | Remote

May 2020 – Present

- Designed, developed, enhanced, and maintained business applications using PHP and Laravel, translating requirements into maintainable backend features and APIs.
- Built and maintained Python-based chatbot or conversational workflows, integrating application logic and external services as required by project needs.
- Contributed to technical architecture and implementation decisions, considering maintainability, reliability, security, and delivery constraints.
- Deployed and hosted applications on Ubuntu servers, configuring Nginx, domain mappings, and HTTPS certificates using Let's Encrypt.
- Used Docker containers to package and deploy applications in server environments; handled environment configuration and deployment troubleshooting.

- Investigated application and production issues across code, configuration, web-server routing, SSL, domains, and containerized services.
- Reviewed code, mentored team members, supported task planning, and coordinated technical delivery for a 5-member team.
- Used Cursor and GitHub Copilot Chat to accelerate development and debugging while reviewing, testing, and validating generated code.

PROJECTS

1. CogChat — AI-Powered Multi-Tenant Chatbot SaaS

Technology: Python, OpenAI APIs, Milvus, PostgreSQL, BM25, Hybrid Retrieval, Hybrid Chunking, Docker, PayPal

- Independently designed and developed an AI-powered, multi-tenant chatbot SaaS application from the ground up.
- Integrated OpenAI embedding models and LLM APIs to support document-based question answering and conversational experiences.
- Implemented vector search using Milvus and BM25 keyword retrieval, combining semantic and lexical search for hybrid retrieval.
- Developed a hybrid chunking strategy to improve document processing and retrieval relevance.
- Integrated PayPal for payment processing and containerized the application using Docker.
- Designed an on-premises deployment option using encrypted binary files to support customer-controlled deployments and protect application assets.

2. Variatel — Telecom Platform for the German Market

Technology: Laravel, PHP, React.js, PostgreSQL, Cron Jobs, Third-Party APIs, Telecom Regulatory Integrations

- Contributed to a production telecom platform serving the German market.
- Developed backend functionality using Laravel and PHP, with React.js for frontend features.
- Integrated third-party APIs from telecom providers and regulatory authorities to support telecom-related business workflows.
- Implemented scheduled background processing using cron jobs.
- Worked on integrations and workflows involving German telecom regulatory requirements.

3. Zoint VC — Video Conferencing Platform

Technology: Laravel, PHP, BigBlueButton (BBB), MySQL, Docker, Ubuntu, Nginx, OpenSSL, Razor pay, Google APIs

- Developed and maintained a Laravel-based video conferencing platform integrated with BigBlueButton.
- Deployed and configured production services on Ubuntu servers using Nginx and OpenSSL for secure hosting.
- Integrated Google Contacts and Calendar to support connected user workflows.
- Integrated Razor pay for payment processing and implemented BigBlueButton webhooks to handle conferencing events.

- Used Docker-based deployment to package and manage application services.

4. AirTopUp — Online Top-Up Platform

Technology: Laravel, PHP, React.js, MySQL, Cron Jobs, Third-Party APIs, PayPal

- Developed backend features for an online top-up platform using Laravel and PHP, with React.js for the frontend.
- Integrated third-party APIs to support platform functionality and external service workflows.
- Implemented scheduled processing through cron jobs.
- Integrated PayPal payment functionality.
- Worked with MySQL for application data storage and management.

LEADERSHIP & DELIVERY

- Team scope: Coordinated and supported a 5-member team.
- Provided technical guidance and recommendations to development teams on backend architecture, API integrations, implementation approaches, and technical challenges.
- Participated in technical discussions and design decisions, recommending suitable solutions based on project requirements, scalability, maintainability, and existing system architecture.
- Coordinated development activities and helped team members resolve technical issues to ensure consistent implementation and adherence to project requirements.
- Conducted code reviews to ensure code quality, maintainability, coding standards, and consistency across projects.
- Guided developers on implementation approaches, debugging, best practices, and resolving technical challenges.
- Supported team members in understanding project requirements, existing codebases, and development workflows while encouraging clean, reusable, and maintainable code.
- Managed and coordinated development teams, assigned tasks, monitored progress, and tracked deliverables using OpenProject.
- Planned and prioritized development activities, followed up on pending tasks, identified technical dependencies, and addressed delivery challenges to keep projects on track.
- Coordinated development, testing, and deployment activities, including managing code pushes to production servers and ensuring successful releases.
- Communicated project progress, technical issues, and delivery updates to relevant stakeholders while ensuring timely completion of assigned deliverables.
- Took ownership of deployment activities, server-side configurations, and production issue resolution to maintain application stability.

EDUCATION

MCA | [Francis Xavier Engg. College | 2018

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Notice period: 1 month

- Preferred location/work mode: Remote
- Portfolio: https://syedsamsudeen.github.io/syed.github.io